

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written on four staves in G-flat major (three flats) and features an irregular meter. The first staff begins with a 2/2 time signature, followed by a 3/2 time signature, and then returns to 2/2. Chord symbols (Eb, Bb, Eb) are placed above the first three measures. The lyrics are: 'As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way, and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.' The second staff ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'. The third staff has chord symbols (Bb, Eb, Ab, Eb) above it and the lyrics: '1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.' The fourth staff has chord symbols (Bb, Eb, Ab, Eb) above it and the lyrics: 'Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.' The score concludes with a double bar line and the marking 'D.C.'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...